

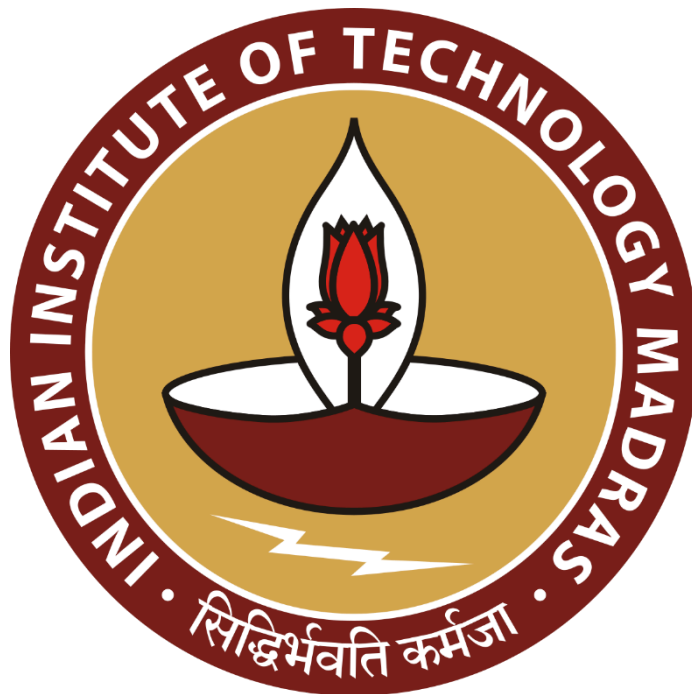
# **The Seasonal Sales and Demand Trends In Sahitya Sadan Bookstore**

## **A Proposal report for the BDM capstone Project**

Submitted by

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## **Declaration Statement**

I am working on a Project titled “The Seasonal Sales and Demand Trends In Sahitya Sadan Bookstore.”. I extend my appreciation to **Sahitya Sadan**, for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered from primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

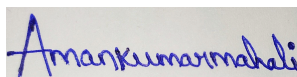
Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis have been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the principles of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I understand that all recommendations made in this project report are within the context of the academic project taken up towards course fulfillment in the BS Degree Program offered by IIT Madras. The institution does not endorse any of the claims or comments.

Signature of Candidate :



Name : Aman Kumar Mahali

Date : 11/07/2025

## **1. Executive Summary**

The project focuses on a small bookstore located at Musabani market, East Singhbhum, Jharkhand. The business is B2C and deals in the segment of stationeries, school books, copies, guidebooks, etc.

The major problems that the bookstore is facing are related to nominal profits due to several reasons such as - overstocking for the low demand products and stockouts for the high demand products on a particular period of time, some items got wasted due to rat bite and some customers give order for some products, but they don't come back to purchase it, etc.

The issues will be addressed by analyzing the data via different analytical approaches to obtain a fruitful outcome. The approach will be to get at least 1 year of data from the bookstore and implement the approaches like data visualization, predictive analytics and strategies to optimize the inventory management by analyzing the trends. And also a qualitative analysis to find the issues that are affecting the business, through discussions with the owner.

The expected outcome is to help the Sahitya Sadan Bookstore, to reduce the money blockage in terms of inventory, and to reduce the wastage of damaged items which will help to enhance the profitability of the business.

## **2. Organization Background**

The name of the bookstore is "Sahitya Sadan" which is a B2C business and is located in the Musabani market, East Singhbhum district, Jharkhand, 832104.

The bookstore was established by Mr. Umakant Sharma in 1972, and he continued the business by putting all his hardwork and dedication in the business, earlier the product list was less as he just started the business so they only sold school copies along with some stationeries, etc. And after gaining some profit from the business, he gradually increased the inventories over the time. After several years the responsibility of the bookstore was given to Mr. Durga Shankar, who put some more money to expand the business, he understood the market and the demand, then he added some more variety of products to increase the profits. And since 2006, the bookstore has been handled by Mr. Jagmohan Patar, who continued with the same spirit and put his hardwork and dedication to lift the business up.

### **3. Problem Statement**

**3.1 Inventory Management Issues :** The business experiences a lot of seasonal trends due to which the issue of overstocking of low demand products and stockouts for the high demand products on a particular period of time arises.

**3.2 Lack of Customer Loyalty :** For the items which currently are not available in the bookstore, some customers give orders in bulk and even after making it available in the bookstore, they don't come back to purchase the same.

**3.3 Lack of protection :** Some items which are kept on the ground get damaged due to rat bites and ultimately they throw away the damaged products which cannot be used or sold.

### **4. Background of the Problem**

#### **Inventory Management Issues :**

The Sahitya Sadan bookstore has a diverse range of products, which includes a variety of books, copies, files, stationery etc. So, sometimes it becomes difficult to track the availability of all the products, and this leads to inefficiencies such as overstocking for low demand products and stockouts for some products whose demand is currently high in the market, on a particular period of time.

#### **Lack of Customer Loyalty :**

The lack of customers loyalty issues arise due to some people who give orders for some products in bulk, but they did not come back to purchase the same due to some reasons. And sometimes what happens is, even though some customers pay the bill in advance for the product, they still don't come back to purchase the same.

#### **Lack of protection :**

The major cause of this problem are rats, since there is a huge variety of products sold in the bookstore, which require a lot of space to keep them, so some of the products are kept on the ground, also there is an issue of rats in that locality, hence some of the products get damaged due to rat bites. And there is no other option than throwing off the damaged and useless items.

## **5. Problem Solving Approach**

To address the problems stated above which are hindering the profits of the business, the problem solving approach would be the following :

### **Details about the methods used :**

The approach would be to analyze the sales data which will help to identify the products, which are not sold for a long time, products which are sold the most throughout the year, products having the high/low margin after selling, for this the pivot tables will be used to identify the same, and also the products whose demand increases/decreases with respect to different seasons/months throughout the year, and for this the pareto charts will be used to identify, and the same chart will also be used to identify the exact months when the sales are increasing/decreasing for the variety of products. The above methods will help to make informed decisions about the different products sold on a particular period of time throughout the year.

### **Details about intended data collection :**

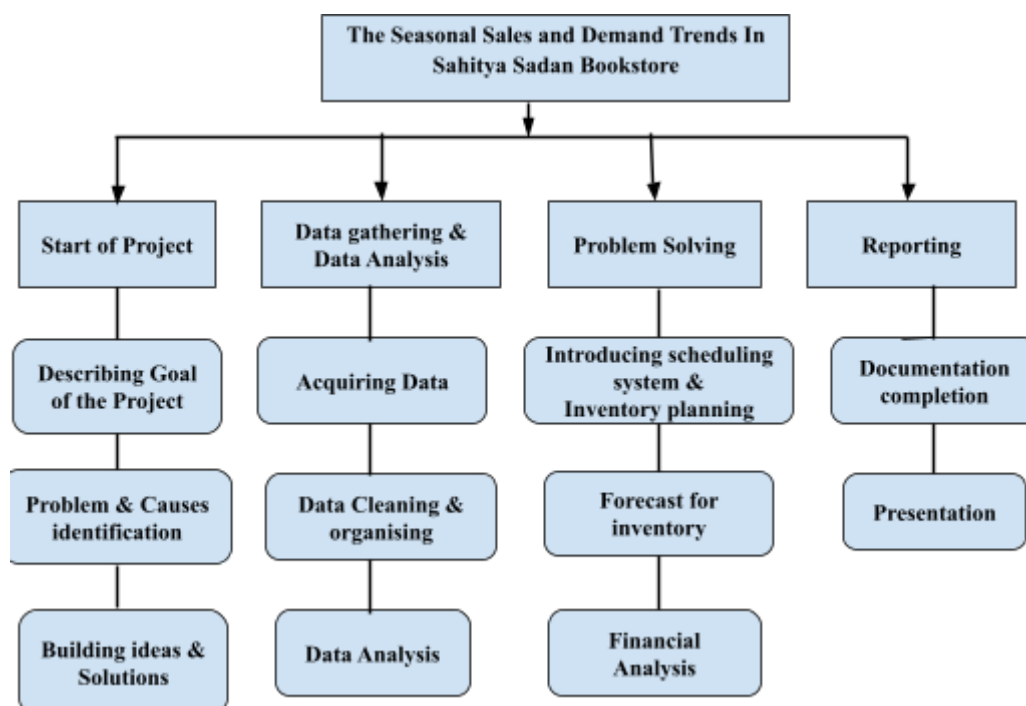
The data collection is the most crucial part of this project, in order to gain an in-depth understanding of the business's statistics, at least one year of the sales, inventory data will be collected from the bookstore which will give the complete insight about the opening stock, closing stock, buying price, selling price, demand, etc. of the products. The collected daily, weekly, monthly or yearly sales data will be used to analyze the different trends, performance and will also be used to calculate the high margin and the profit margin of products. Additionally, the qualitative data would be gathered through interaction with the owner, to better understand the ways which may increase the profits of the business.

### **Details about the analysis tools :**

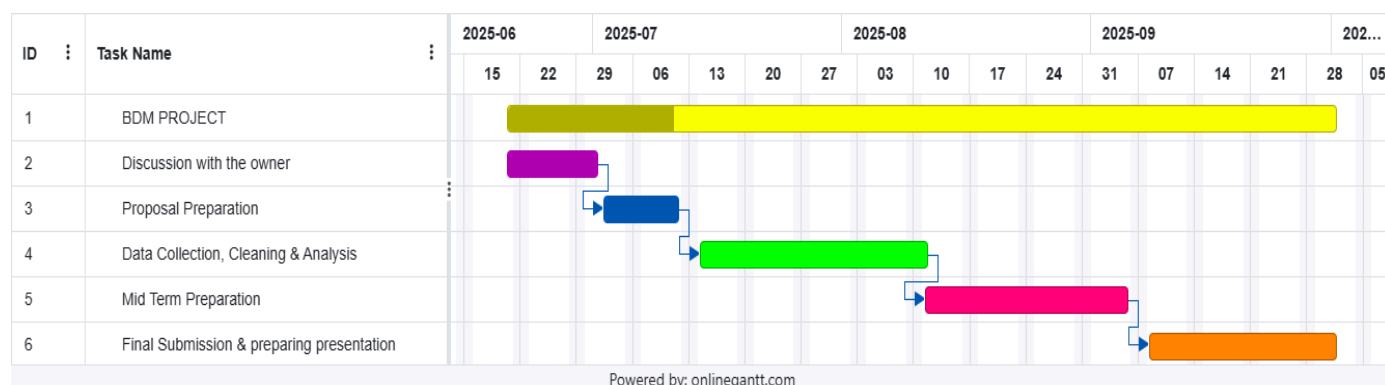
After collecting the data of inventory, sales and purchase, the data will be analysed through different charts as per the requirement like pie chart to display percentages, histogram to check the frequency distribution, scatter plot to identify the correlation between two variables, pivot tables which are used to summarize the data, and various functions like VLOOKUP, COUNTIF, COUNTIFS, etc. All these can be done using Microsoft Excel which will help to analyze and organize the data efficiently. Based on the past sales performance and the different analysis of the collected data, we can predict the future inventory requirements to reduce the chances of both overstock and the stockouts.

## 6. Expected Timeline

### 6.1 Work Breakdown Structure :



### 6.2 Gantt Chart :



## 7. Expected Outcome

The expected outcome is to improve the Inventory planning of the bookstore, which will reduce the issue of overstocking for the low demand products and stockouts for the high demand products. The analysis of the historical data collected from the bookstore, will help to know about the different sales and demand trends seen throughout the year, which will lead to better planning for the future requirements. Additionally, the identification of high and low margin products will help to increase the profits of the business.